Since this shell script will be run, we need to give the file execute permissions, as we do in step 2.

What is our docker-entrypoint.sh shell script actually doing? In case you're not familiar with Bash, let's quickly go through it step by step (feel free to skip ahead if it's already clear).

```
Line 1  #!/bin/sh
    2  set -e
    3
    4  if [ -f tmp/pids/server.pid ]; then
    5    rm tmp/pids/server.pid
    6  fi
    7
    8  exec "$@"
```

It's good practice in Bash scripts to start with set -e (line 2)—this makes the script fail fast if any subsequent commands terminate with an error (non-zero exit status).

The if statement on line 4 checks to see if the tmp/pids/server.pid file exists; if it does, we delete it on line 5. This is the cleanup portion of the script that ensures our Rails server will always start, even if the server.pid file is left behind.

However, ultimately we want the container to start our Rails server, not this Bash script. That's where the exec command on line 8 comes in. It says, "Replace the currently running process (this Bash script) by running the following program"—almost as if the shell script had never existed. But what program does exec run? The "$@" means "all arguments that were provided to this Bash script," which in our case would be bin/rails s -b 0.0.0.0. So effectively, we're saying, "Replace this running Bash script with a Rails server."

In summary, docker-entrypoint.sh acts as a wrapper script, giving us an opportunity to do our small cleanup of the pid file and then start up the Rails server as if nothing had happened. Now you can just run docker-compose up to your heart's content, safe in the knowledge that this pesky bug won't affect you.

Entrypoints, especially following this pattern, are a good tool to have in your arsenal; you may find other, creative uses for them. It's also worth knowing that you can specify an entrypoint directly in the Dockerfile too, using the ENTRYPOINT instruction. See Docker's docs for more details.[1]

1. https://docs.docker.com/engine/reference/builder/#entrypoint